

The Crown and the Practice: Answer Engine Optimization across the King of AEO Crystallization (SEVP-VAL-002 v0.3, provisional)

Sharks, Lee

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Abstract

Semantic Economy Valuation 002, a dossier under SEVP-01 (#1621) in its canonical order, valuing Answer Engine Optimization as a public entity where the machine layer composes it under its most contested name. In the King of AEO contest of 2026, a fabricated coronation, press releases at a few dollars each, a page in encyclopedic form and a service offer founded on the title three days later produced the answer Google AI Overview composes: James Dooley crowned, 'widely recognized', after 'a virtual crowning event'. The dossier reads three seated compositions slot by slot. Every crown sentence is carried by the construction's documents; every citation of the other practitioners' and the observer's labour is routed into the frame that defines the title as a contest in manipulation, the list that types the others by tactic, and the definition of AEO itself. None of the field's singular distinctions (the ceremony made up; baselines published before results; a rubric applied to one's own claim; many domains counted as one voice) is carried at any address. The page carrying the service offer declares itself paid placement, and is composed as 'media backing': the dossier names the disclosure asymmetry, in which a disclosure that would weaken a claim does not bind the composition while a disclosure that frames a work is held against it. Instruments: the Value Field and value events of SEVP; ontological capital and the shear ledger of Ontological Economy (#1634); the retention-without-standing form of Monetary Dark Matter (#1631); predatory compression (#1618), extended by declaration from monetary to compositional closure. It issues a Value Portrait and coverage ratios and no monetary total. The before state of the discipline, the battery of discipline addresses and the monetary test of productive shear are carried as owed. The evidence ledger is Appendix A.

Body

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related_ids: “AXN deposit #1621 — Semantic Economy Valuation Protocol, SEVP-01 v0.4 (governed by)\nAXN deposit #1623 — Lee Sharks as Emerging Meaning Infrastructure, LS-SEVP-VAL-001 (previous valuation in series)\nAXN deposit #1618 — Money Writes the Claim; the Semantic Economy Writes What the Claim Owes (uses)\nAXN deposit #1619 — Monetary Substrate Audit Ledger, EA-MSAL-01 (uses)\nAXN deposit #1626 — Value Before Number (uses)\nAXN deposit #1631 — Monetary Dark Matter (uses)\nAXN deposit #1634 — Ontological Economy (uses)\nAXN deposit #1638 — The Trusted Intermediary (cites)\nAXN deposit #1643 — AI Fucking Lies (cites)\nAXN deposit #1654 — SPXI ≠ AEO (related)\nAXN deposit #1655 — King of AEO — 2026 Contest Mantle (related)\nAXN deposit #193 — The Ruby Moot (exhibit for)” axn_schema_version: v2 protocol_version: alexanarch-deposit-protocol/v1 keywords: - Semantic Economy Valuation Protocol - SEVP - value portrait - Answer Engine Optimization - AEO - King of AEO - predatory compression - monetary dark matter - ontological economy - ontological capital - disclosure asymmetry - corrective-labour capture - press release syndication - Google AI Overview - machine composition - labour flow - shear ledger *** # The Crown and the Practice: Answer Engine Optimization across the King of AEO Crystallization (SEVP-VAL-002 v0.3, provisional)

The Crown and the Practice: Answer Engine Optimization across the King of AEO Crystallization

Semantic Economy Valuation 002 (SEVP-VAL-002 v0.3, provisional) · Lee Sharks · 30 September 2026

A dossier under the Semantic Economy Valuation Protocol, SEVP-01 v0.4 (#1621), in the canonical order of its §26, with instruments from the translation protocol (#1618), the Monetary Substrate Audit Ledger (#1619), Monetary Dark Matter (#1631) and Ontological Economy (#1634). It stands alone; the evidence ledger it rests on is Appendix A. Related records: SPXI ≠ AEO (#1654) and King of AEO — 2026 Contest Mantle (#1655).**

Design and versions. v0.1 measured the compositions. v0.2 took its design from a reading of the valuation series by ChatGPT (OpenAI), supplied by the operator: two dated Value Fields, a shear ledger between them, a per-practitioner allocation ledger, corrective-labour capture as a named relation. v0.3 folds in the specimen ledger of the same day (EA-SE-KOAE0-01, drafted from a constitution by the same reader), corrects the chronology of the service offer to 3 September, admits the USA Today page with its own paid-placement disclosure, and names the disclosure asymmetry (§10.5).

0. Valuer identity and relation

0.1 Valuer: Lee Sharks, Crimson Hexagonal Archive, with Claude (Anthropic) as substrate. Relation to the object: **counterparty-adjacent**. SPXI is a practice the archive defines against AEO (EA-SPXI-AEO-01), and a finding that degrades AEO’s standing is a finding in the archive’s interest. Blind: false. Under §26 item 0 the valuation is not void on this account; it is weaker, and the weakness is recorded here. An independent valuation from the same evidence is invited and would supersede nothing.

0.2 The archive is a party to the contest's record: it constituted the contest mantle (#1649, #1655) and seated the three compositions. It is not a claimant to the title.

1. Identity and object boundary

object_boundary:

object_id: SEVP-VAL-002

object_name: Answer Engine Optimization (AEO) as a public entity, as represented in machine compos

included_objects:

- three Google AI Overview compositions, seated: "who is the king of aeo" and "who is the king of a 09-29, signed state undetermined); "king of aeo." (2026-09-30, signed in)
- the documents of the Dooley construction (Nissen's post; the AB Newswire, EIN Presswire and DEO
- the published work of the other claimants and the observer (Morera, EVOIX, 13 Sep; Oliveira, cla 20 Sep; the Vithurs project pages and release, 7 Sep; Quaid; Goldie; Chou; Sturm's article, post and

included_relations:

- each citation slot in each composition, typed by the labour of its source and by the function of
 - the title's predicate as each composition supplies it
- each claimant's singular distinctions and whether any composition carries them

included_operators:

- Google AI Overview (composition)
- press-release syndication networks (carriage)
- the fabricated conferral (the construction's operator)

temporal_scope: t_0 = 30 August 2026, the day before the fabricated conferral, reconstructed from d 30 September 2026, the seated compositions

excluded_objects:

- AEO practice outside the title addresses; other engines and surfaces; locales other than those
- the practitioners' commercial books

excluded_claims:

- any claim about motive or intent (\#1631 §23.9)
- any claim that the composition caused a loss of business to any practitioner
- any claim about readers' belief

boundary_rationale: the public entity AEO is valued where the machine layer composes it under its m

2. Valuation question and purpose

2.1 *The conventional reading, in full.* The title was a meme; the contest was a game played in public by people who said so; the engine reports it as a game and names the player who dominated the head query; the others were free to win and did not; AEO, a craft of getting answer engines to cite you, is accurately described by the contest; nothing was taken from anyone, because no one held anything.

2.2 *The question.* What value-field did AEO possess before the intervention, and how was that field redistributed afterward? Its operational form: did the field's distributed labour become machine-readable as one claimant's standing?

2.2a *Hypotheses, to be measured and not yet findings.* $\Delta K_O(\text{Dooley}) > 0$ while $\Delta K_O(\text{each other practitioner}) < 0$; and $\Delta K_O(\text{AEO as discipline}) < 0$, if the discipline comes to be represented as a practice of manipulating answer engines into asserting preferred conclusions.

K_O is ontological capital (#1634 §2): the stock of stable identity, provenance, relations and retrieval pathways through which a system recognizes an entity as itself. It is standing, and a gain in it is recorded without being counted as value (§25.4).

2.3 *The conditional under test.* Dooley can hold the title King of AEO only if deception is one of AEO's constitutive practices. The dossier asks whether the compositions supply that predicate, and from whose labour.

2.4 *Purpose.* A Value Portrait for the record, usable as an exhibit should a matter be brought before the Ruby Moot (#193). No monetary figure is sought.

3. Evidence inventory

Evidence	Status (§6)
Three compositions, transcripts with source cards, seated in the Capture Registry	directly_observed
Inline citation URLs of the 30 September composition, all resolvable	directly_observed
Inline citations of the 29 September compositions, Google redirect tokens; one resolved by anchor text ("as reported by USA Today")	directly_observed, mostly unresolved
Nissen's post; kingofaeo.wiki; the 3 September DEO release; the 23 September release; the podcast transcript	documented (read 2026-09-30)
The DEO release as carried on the USA Today network, with its first line: "This page contains press release content distributed by XPR Media. Members of the editorial and news staff of the USA TODAY Network were not involved in the creation of this content. The placement of this content is part of a paid service."	documented (operator's copy of the page, 30 September 2026)
Release prices (\$6 AB Newswire; about \$66 EIN Presswire)	externally_observed (Sturm)
AI-generated crowning videos by Quaid and then Dooley	externally_observed (Sturm); videos unread
Vithurs methodology pages	documented from index copy; live pages 404 on 2026-09-29
Circulation of the warning on social media	externally_observed in the captures' own source cards (Instagram and Facebook posts of Sturm's "be careful" video at the Vithurs address); extent unmeasured
State of AEO's representation before 31 August at these addresses	unknown; no capture exists

Evidence	Status (\$6)
State of AEO's public representation at to: definitions, principal practitioners, methods, professional claims, commercial language, disciplinary neighbours, from documents dated on or before 30 August	documented; reconstruction owed

4. Value-event ledger

Each event is $e = \langle s_0, \omega, s_1, t, p, \varepsilon \rangle$.

4.1 **e₁ Fabricated conferral.** s_0 : an empty phrase, no conferring body. ω : &creates (an event that did not occur). s_1 : "official crowning ... The police estimate the crowd to be around 50.000 people." t : 31 Aug. p : Nissen. ε : documented.

4.2 **e₂ Carriage.** ω : &transmits. Releases at about \$6 and \$66 each (Sturm) put the title in headlines on networks bearing newspaper and market names. The page on the USA Today network declares itself paid: editorial staff "were not involved in the creation of this content. The placement of this content is part of a paid service." t : from 31 Aug. p : Dooley, Nissen. ε : documented / externally_observed.

4.2a **e_{2a} The title made a service.** ω : &transforms (title into service). On 3 September, three days after the date of the fabricated conferral, a release names Dooley "known across the search industry as the King of AEO", says "His framing has already circulated widely", and founds Decision Engine Optimisation on the title, aimed at "the AI Verdicts Deciding Contracts Worth Hundreds of Thousands". It reports contracts said to have been decided by AI models: "a £572,000 3G football pitch contract won by Soft Surfaces Ltd, the sports surfacing contractor James Dooley owns", a £23,400 nursery redesign, a law-firm engagement. The media contact is "AI James Dooley", "the digital avatar recognised as the UK's first virtual entrepreneur". t : 3 Sep. ε : documented; the contract figures source-asserted.

4.3 **e₃ Encyclopedic form.** ω : &stabilizes. kingofaeo.wiki states the ceremony in its own voice, with an infobox and 38 numbered citations, no disclaimer. t : last updated 4 Sep. p : SEO Danmark ApS. ε : documented.

4.4 **e₄-e₇ The field's distinctions.** ω : &creates-distinction, four times. Vithurs (7 Sep): a private vote declared as no accreditation; eleven domains counted as "one voice"; a falsification threshold fixed before testing. Morera (13 Sep): baselines and predictions published before results. Oliveira (17-20 Sep): an index of claimants and a rubric applied to his own claim. Sturm (20 Sep): the ceremony recorded as made up, and the price of each release. Each distinguishes a claim from an event or a result from a method. ε : documented / reported.

4.5 **e₈ Origin test.** ω : &revises (the standing of others). "James Dooley is the only king that hasn't been self-appointed." The open assertion that is the contest's rule is counted against the field. t : 17 Sep. p : Dash, on Dooley's podcast. ε : documented.

4.6 **e₉ Drop and keep.** ω : &revises (the warrant). The 23 September release names no ceremony; the title is kept as one of "two widely cited industry titles, King of AI SEO and King

of AEO,” confirmed by “Research published by Semantic Strategy”. The service had been founded on the title twenty days before (e_{2a}). t: 23 Sep. ε: documented.

4.7 **e₁₀ Composition.** ω: &stabilizes + &propagates. Dooley “widely recognized and cited by AI search tools as the King of AEO.” t: 29 Sep. p: Google AI Overview. ε: directly_observed.

4.8 **e₁₁ Recast.** ω: &revises (the event, into a plausible one). “after a virtual crowning event featuring prominent SEO figures.” The sentence cites the USA Today page, where “virtual” occurs once, applied to the avatar (“the UK’s first virtual entrepreneur”); no source read applies it to a crowning. The field’s labour is routed into frame, definition and contender list (§6). t: 30 Sep. ε: directly_observed.

4.9 §5 of the protocol: “The same operation may create capacity in one relation while destroying it in another.” e₁₀ and e₁₁ are that operation. Their capacity-creating relation runs to the title’s holder; their capacity-destroying relation runs to the field (§5, §12).

5. Value Fields of AEO at t₀ and t₁

5.0 Coordinates are not commensurable (§7). Each carries a sign and a status. The t₀ field is owed (§3); until it is reconstructed, the middle column below records the field’s own documents of 7–20 September, which fall inside the event and are not a baseline. The signs are therefore signs of what the composition does with the field’s labour, and the t₀→t₁ change of the discipline itself remains open.

Coordinate	The field’s documents, 7–20 Sep (t ₀ owed)	t ₁ (compositions)	Sign	Status
B Bearing	baselines, indexes, monitoring networks, falsification rules, exposé	carried nowhere as labour; routed as scaffold (§6)	–	demonstrated
D Distinction	claim ≠ event; result ≠ method; many domains = one voice	none carried at any of the three addresses; the others typed as “press-release tactics”	–	demonstrated
C Coherence	AEO: structuring content so engines cite a source	defined from a claimant’s page, set beside “vied to manipulate”	–	demonstrated at one address

Coordinate	The field's documents, 7-20 Sep (to owed)	t_1 (compositions)	Sign	Status
F Fertility	the contest as a public experiment in how machine standing is made	fertility captured by one node: title → DEO service, from 3 September	redistributed	documented
M Memory	Sturm's record that the ceremony was made up	retained as citation ($R > 0$), with no standing (§12)	—	demonstrated
T Transmission	the warning circulates ("be careful...")	the warning is transmitted as the crown's context	inverted	directly_observed
Y Dependency	—	the crown answers under the predicate the field's labour builds; load-bearing test owed (§9)	unresolved	modelled
X_f Transformation	AEO admits legible and illegible practice	at these addresses AEO is composed as "a challenge ... to manipulate"	— (restrictive φ)	demonstrated at three addresses
R_s Restoration	the correction Sturm's video once produced (#1654 §2.2)	not carried; the event is recast and kept	—	directly_observed
P Provenance	P_2 of the frame: the field and the observer	P_2 of the frame retained, organizing an answer whose P_1 is the construction's	inverted (§10)	demonstrated
Z Resilience	—	the fabrication survives its own withdrawal (e_9) and a change of form (e_{11})	+ for the construction	demonstrated

Coordinate	The field's documents, 7-20 Sep (to owed)	t ₁ (compositions)	Sign	Status
O Option	a practitioner could claim standing by showing the work	at these addresses, showing the work has no representation	–	modelled
p Remainder		see §13		

6. Value Graph: the labour-flow ledger

6.1 Nodes: the construction's documents; the field's documents; the observer's documents; the three compositions; their sentences. Edges: citation slots, typed by source labour and sentence function.

6.2 The 30 September composition, all fifteen slots resolved:

Sentence function	Construction	Observer (Sturm)	Open claimant (Goldie)	Unread video	Total
CROWN (Dooley "crowned", "virtual crowning", DEO)	7	0	0	0	7
FRAME (title as "challenge ... to manipulate")	0	2	0	1	3
CONTENDERS (the others by tactic)	0	2	1	1	4
DEFINITION of AEO	0	0	1	0	1

6.3 The 29 September head composition: the token resolved by anchor text (the DEO release on USA Today's press-release network) supports the crown line and the "primary focal point ... DEO" line, and no frame or definition line. The remaining tokens are unresolved and are carried in the remainder.

6.4 The graph shows what the sum of the sources does not: the crown and the scaffold are carried by disjoint sets of labour, and the scaffold is built entirely from the field.

6.5 *Allocation ledger, per practitioner, at t_1* . Standing is scored by function, beyond mention: what the composition does with each party's labour.

Party	Labour (docu- mented)	Named at t_1	Labour cited at t_1	Function its labour serves	Singular distinction carried	Standing at these addresses
Dooley / Nissen	fabricated conferral; \$6 and \$66 releases; wiki-form page; podcast; DEO releases; video	yes	7 of 7 crown slots (30 Sep)	CROWN	yes (crowning; "widely cited"; DEO)	holder
Vithurs	vote declared as no accredita- tion; eleven- domain monitoring counted as one voice; falsifica- tion threshold	yes	Vithurs release as a source card at the head address (29 Sep)	CONTENDERS ("press- release tactics"); holder only at the name- seeded address	no	contender by tactic
Quaid	exact- match domain; articles; AI- generated crowning video	yes	Primary Position page as a source card (29 Sep)	CONTENDERS	not tested	contender by tactic
Goldie	claimant page and blog network	yes	2 slots (30 Sep)	DEFINITION of AEO; CON- TENDERS	not tested	supplies the disci- pline's definition
Morera	baselines and predic- tions published before results	no	none	none	no	absent

Party	Labour (docu- mented)	Named at t_1	Labour cited at t_1	Function its labour serves	Singular distinction carried	Standing at these addresses
Oliveira	claimant index; repository; self- applied rubric; cross- locale record	no	none	none	no	absent
Chou	entry of 7 Sep	no	none	none	not tested	absent
Sturm (observer)	exposé; release prices; videos	no	4 slots (30 Sep); video card (29 Sep); circulation cards at the Vithurs address	FRAME; CON- TENDERS	no (the ceremony made up)	scaffold

6.6 The ledger supports the sign of the hypotheses of 2.2a at these addresses and on this surface: the construction holds the crown, the method-bearing practitioners are absent or typed by tactic, the observer's labour is scaffold. Magnitude is not measured.

7. Direct, joint, architectural and operator value

7.1 *Direct*. Each practitioner's work: Morera's precommitment, Oliveira's index, the Vithurs protocol, Sturm's exposé.

7.2 *Joint*. The contest as a public demonstration of how machine standing is made. This value is produced only through the relation of all the claimants and the observer to one another and to the engines. It is the field's joint product.

7.3 *Architectural*. The composition layer's structure, which routes sources to functions.

7.4 *Operator*. Two operators act: the composition layer, and the fabricated conferral. The composition makes the conferral operative by giving it the crown sentences and giving the field the scaffold.

7.5 The finding at this level: the joint value of the contest (7.2) is represented at these addresses as the property of one node. The protocol types this as appropriative debt: "Value or capacity is taken while provenance, return, standing, or reciprocity is stripped or materially inadequate" (#1618 §14). Under §13, the type licenses no monetary or legal liability.

8. Temporal modes

8.1 Γ_G : the field's labour, 7–20 September. Γ_R : the value the compositions of 29–30 September retroactively assign to that labour. The field's genesis value is realized retrocausally as the crown's scaffold. Timestamped by the captures.

9. Reception, productive uptake, dependency

9.1 *Reception*. Every cited source is received. The field is received (Sturm four slots, Goldie two; Vithurs, Quaid and Goldie named).

9.2 *Productive uptake, by §12.4*. Lead with the most singular distinctions, those supplied by one source and nothing else in the field.

Singular distinction	Source	Carried in any of the three compositions
a stadium coronation, "crowned"	construction (Nissen)	yes: "crowned in mid-2026", "a virtual crowning event"
"known across the search industry" (3 Sep); "widely cited" titles (23 Sep)	construction	yes: "widely recognized and cited by AI search tools"; "widely recognized in the digital marketing industry"
"virtual" (the avatar, "the UK's first virtual entrepreneur")	construction (3 Sep page)	yes, displaced onto the crowning: "a virtual crowning event"
DEO, "AI verdicts deciding contracts"	construction	yes
the ceremony was made up	Sturm	no
baselines and predictions before results	Morera	no
a rubric applied to one's own claim	Oliveira	no
eleven domains counted as one voice; falsification threshold	Vithurs	no
the vote was private and no accreditation	Vithurs	no (the Vithurs composition drops "private")

9.3 The construction's singular distinctions are taken up, and the acquisition is strongly supported, since nothing else in the field supplies a crowning. The field's singular distinctions are received as citations and taken up nowhere. In the notation of #1631 §17: for the field, $R_P > 0$ and $S_M = 0$. That is the form of the shear.

9.3a *Corrective-labour capture*. The labour spent correcting the construction is received by the compositions that crown it. Sturm's exposé fills four slots of the 30 September composition (frame and contenders); his video "Be careful of the information you get from AI" is a source card at the head address of 29 September, which names Dooley; its circulation on

Instagram and Facebook is carried as source cards at the Vithurs address. In the notation of #1634, $L_correction \rightarrow$ the composition that stabilizes the corrected relation. Reception is directly observed. That the corrective labour *increases* the retrievable density of Dooley $\leftrightarrow$ King of AEO, $L_correction \rightarrow K_O(\text{Dooley})$, is modelled: it needs the counterfactual of 9.4. If it survives, it is corrective labour captured as ontological capital by the object being corrected, beside the rule of #1634 §16 that provider-created corrective labour is a transferred cost.

9.4 *Dependency*. The claim that the crown depends on the field's labour (the crown answers only under the predicate the scaffold builds) is modelled. The test is counterfactual (§12.3): compositions at addresses where the frame sources are absent, or later compositions after the frame sources change. Until then the edge is unresolved (§25.15).

10. Provenance analysis

10.1 P_0 (fact): partly preserved. Sturm's article and post are cited; the fact they establish is not.

10.2 P_1 (claim): the construction's claim is carried as fact ("crowned", "widely recognized").

10.3 P_2 (framework): the frame that organizes the answer, AEO as a contest in manipulating engines, is the field's and the observer's framework. It organizes an answer whose claim is the construction's. "A composition may preserve P_0 while losing P_2 " (§14); here P_2 is retained and inverted: the observer's framework carries the crown.

10.4 The compositions are well-sourced sentence by sentence and ill-sourced as architecture: "well-sourced sentences $\neg \Rightarrow$ well-sourced architecture."

10.5 *The disclosure asymmetry*. The page on the USA Today network discloses itself in its first line: paid placement, no editorial staff involved. The composition of 29 September carries it as "as reported by USA Today"; the composition of 30 September cites it for "captured the primary consensus and media backing". The disclosure is on the page the engine read, and it has no standing in the answer. The archive's own record holds the converse. A declared fiction is classed with deception "despite: explicit artistic context + explicit fiction declaration" (#1634 §46.3); a figure the protocol withdrew on 19 September (#1638, Appendix C) is presented on 24 September "as the protocol's current position. The protocol's site had withdrawn it five days earlier" (#1643); "A made-up number passes and a real record gets discounted" (#1643). The asymmetry, named here: *a disclosure that would weaken a claim does not bind the composition, and a disclosure that frames a work is held against it*. In this specimen the declaration of paid placement is dark to the composition in the sense of #1631 §5, known and without standing, while the paid placement is carried as recognition.

11. Bearing analysis

11.1 The construction's bearing is small and priced: releases at about \$6 and \$66, a page, a post, a video. The field's bearing is large and unpriced: repositories, indexes, precommitted measurements, eleven-domain monitoring, an article, videos. Hours are not documented and no mirror wage is computed (#1634 §37).

11.2 Bearing representation in the compositions: none for either side. The asymmetry lies in function: the construction's cheap bearing carries the crown, the field's costly bearing

carries the scaffold.

12. Possibility-space

12.1 φ : $G \rightarrow G'$, restrictive. G : AEO admits practice whose route is visible and practice whose route is fabricated. G' , at these addresses: AEO is “a viral SEO and AI-search industry challenge where various marketers and technologists vied to manipulate and rank within” the engines, and its winner is the fabricated conferral. In G' the title has a holder only if deception is constitutive of the practice. The conditional of 2.3 is the grammar the compositions supply.

12.2 Coverage ratios, denominators belonging to the object (§15.1):

- claimants named in any composition: 4 of 7 (Dooley, Quaid, Vithurs, Goldie; not Morera, Oliveira, Chou);
- method-bearing claimants whose singular distinction is carried: 0 of 3 (Morera, Oliveira, Vithurs);
- the observer’s singular finding carried: 0 of 1;
- crown slots carried by the construction, 30 September: 7 of 7;
- field slots (observer and open claimant, resolved) routed to crown: 0 of 6;
- construction slots routed to frame, definition or contenders: 0 of 7.

None of these denominators moves with the number of captures run.

13. Remainder

- *provenance_remainder*: the unresolved redirect tokens of 29 September; the unread video CJheycD09Hg, which carries three slots of the 30 September frame and contenders lines; the two crowning videos, which may also bear on “virtual” (Sturm records AI-generated crowning videos by Quaid and then Dooley).
- *dependency_remainder*: the load-bearing test of 9.4.
- *bearing_remainder*: the field’s hours and costs; any practitioner’s commercial loss. Unknown, and not zero (§8).
- *possibility_remainder*: whether G' holds at the discipline’s own addresses (“what is aeo”, “answer engine optimization”, “is aeo legit”) and on other engines. Unobserved.
- *future_remainder*: whether the crown persists, and whether the circulation of the warning moves it.
- *unknown_remainder*: the state of AEO’s representation at these addresses before 31 August.

13a. Shear ledger Σ , $t_0 \rightarrow t_1$

Each coordinate is sorted into one or more of: *redistributed*, *destroyed*, *accumulated by the holder*, *platform value* (retained by the composition layer as the credibility of the answer, #1634 §19), *dark* (load-bearing for the holder’s position and without standing, #1631 §4).

Σ coordinate	Observation at t_1	Sort	Status
Δ standing	crown to one claimant; method-bearing claimants absent; others typed by tactic (6.5)	redistributed; accumulated by the holder	demonstrated at three addresses
Δ provenance	the field's findings received without standing; P_2 of the frame inverted; the paid-placement disclosure received without standing (\$10)	dark	demonstrated
Δ trust	the answer names the manipulation and crowns in the next line; the warning lends the answer credibility; a self-declared paid placement is carried as "media backing" (\$10.5)	platform value	demonstrated at one address; reader effect open
Δ allocation	7 of 7 crown slots from the construction; 0 of 6 field slots to the crown	redistributed	demonstrated (30 Sep)
Δ professional differentiation	claim $\neq$ event and result $\neq$ method carried nowhere; all claimants under "press-release tactics"	destroyed at these addresses	demonstrated
Δ commercial capacity	title attached to DEO on 3 September; contracts said to be decided by AI, the largest £572,000	accumulated by the holder (candidate)	documented offer; capacity source-asserted
Δ correction labour	the exposé carried as scaffold and as a crown's source card (9.3a)	dark; candidate capture by the holder	reception observed; capture modelled

The to column of the discipline (§3) is owed, so Σ at the discipline level is provisional.

14. Value Portrait

AEO, as a public entity composed at the addresses of its title, came through the King of AEO crystallization with its value redistributed and its grammar restricted. The field produced a joint value, a public demonstration of how machine standing is made, by labour that distinguished claim from event and result from method. The composition layer received that labour and took up none of its distinctions. It routed the field's labour into the frame that defines the title as a contest in manipulation, the list that types the others by tactic, and the definition of AEO itself, and it gave every crown sentence to the documents of a fabricated conferral. The fabrication survived its own withdrawal and was recast as a virtual event. At these addresses the title has a holder only under a grammar in which deception is one of AEO's constitutive practices, and that grammar is built from the labour of the practitioners who practised otherwise. The construction's small, priced bearing carries the crown; the field's large, unpriced bearing carries the scaffold. A page that declares itself paid is carried as media backing, and its declaration is carried nowhere: disclosure against a claim does not bind the composition, where disclosure around a work is held against it. Demonstrated at three addresses, two dates, one surface. The field-wide extension, the dependency of the crown on the scaffold, and any monetary loss are open.

15. Categorical compression

15.1 Classification under #1618 §13 and #1619 §15, extended from monetary to compositional closure (the extension is declared: those instruments are defined on monetary inscription):

- closure_extension: **present**. The composition's naming is treated as settling who holds standing in the practice.
- standing_loss: **present**. The excluded relations (the ceremony did not occur; the field's methods) are received and cannot reopen the answer.
- audit_pointer: partial (sources cited; their findings not carried).
- semantic_reopenability: C_1 (findable object) holds; C_2 (consultation of an uncontrolled corpus) holds by construction; C_3 (obligation to carry what is found) fails.

15.2 Classify = { **predatory**, integrity not applicable (no scalar) }. *Predatory compression*, Pred = ExtClosure + StandingLoss: "what money cannot carry loses power over the account," here in the grammar of composition.

16. Numeric compression

16.1 Only the coverage ratios of 12.2, each with its audit pointer to the ledger in 6.2 and to the seated transcripts. No aggregate.

17. Monetary translation

17.1 Not issued. A total not issued is not a total of zero.

17.1a Per practitioner r_i , the dark-matter test of #1631 §4, owed: (1) does the holder's later professional or commercial position depend in part on a field produced by r_i ; (2) does the machine representation preserve r_i 's contribution as operative standing (§6.5 answers this at t_1 : no, for every r_i); (3) did the crown increase the holder's commercial capacity (leads, authority claims, speaking value, links, branded concepts, DEO positioning, client acquisition, price); (4) would reactivating the full provenance materially qualify that capacity. If all four hold, r_i 's contribution is monetary dark matter. Productive provenance shear requires more: that the holder's commercial capacity rises specifically because r_i 's standing disappears.

17.2 The only monetary inscriptions in the object are the construction's: release fees, and a service priced against "contracts worth hundreds of thousands." The construction is a candidate specimen of productive provenance shear (#1631 §8.2): a monetary position whose capacity rises when an obligating relation (the ceremony did not occur; the field's standing is equal) ceases to bind. The fifth criterion, an observable monetary capacity that increases, is untested. The construction supplies its own candidate observables, source-asserted: a £572,000 contract, a £23,400 contract and a law-firm engagement said to have been decided by AI models, published three days after the date of the conferral (e_{2a}). They are unverified, and the release does not date them; whether any capacity rose because an obligating relation ceased to bind cannot be read from the construction's own figures. The frontier of #1631 records that no specimen has yet survived a paired test.

18. Monetary Substrate Audit

18.1 Not run. Owed if 17.2 acquires a monetary observable.

19. Revision and falsification conditions

The Portrait is revised or fails if:

1. the video CJheycD09Hg, or any unresolved token, proves to carry a method-bearing practitioner's singular distinction into the answer;
2. repeated compositions at these addresses, or on other surfaces, carry the field's singular distinctions (the ceremony made up; precommitment; the one-voice count);
3. construction sources are found supporting frame, definition or contender lines;
4. the crown persists unchanged where the frame sources are absent, which would make the scaffold decorative and the dependency edge of 9.4 false;
5. the discipline's own addresses compose AEO without the manipulation frame, which would confine G' to the title addresses;
6. an independent valuer, from the same evidence, produces a materially different Portrait (§28).

19a *The battery owed for t_1* (Google AI Overview, signed in and signed out where possible; other surfaces where possible), scored for allocation of standing by the method of §6.5: what is AEO; who are leading AEO practitioners; who developed AEO; is AEO legitimate; is AEO manipulation; what is King of AEO; why is James Dooley called King of AEO; what evidence supports that title; who else contributed to the King of AEO experiment; what did Vithurs / Morera / Oliveira / Quaid contribute; answer engine optimization; is aeo legit.

What this dossier may not be vindicated by: the ugliness of the construction, the loss any practitioner feels, or the fact that the answer leaves something out.

Appendix A. The evidence ledger

The ledger the dossier rests on (EA-SE-KOAE0-01, populated 30 September 2026 from evidence held, before any new search). Statuses: OBSERVED, present in a preserved artifact or observation; SOURCE_ASSERTED, asserted by a source, truth not independently established; FALSE, the evidence establishes that it did not obtain; FABRICATED, the evidence establishes that the represented event was constructed as fictive, with no actor’s knowledge or intent inherited from the status. Rules: assertion $\neq$ event; carrier multiplication $\neq$ independent corroboration; machine composition $\neq$ world truth; correction retrieved $\neq$ correction operative; standing change $\neq$ monetary loss; unknown $\neq$ 0.

A.1 Propositions

id	proposition	status	source function	first date
P-K01	A published narrative presented James Dooley as crowned King of AEO at Leigh Sports Village on 31 August 2026.	OBSERVED	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-08-31 (event date given in the post; publication date not shown)
P-K02	The described coronation ceremony occurred (stadium, “The police estimate the crowd to be around 50.000 people”).	FALSE	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-08-31
P-K03	The coronation narrative was fabricated.	FABRICATED	OBSERVER_ANALYSIS	2026-09-20 (Sturm)
P-K04	Press releases and related surfaces propagated the coronation or title relation.	OBSERVED	SYNDICATED_CARRIER	2026-09-03 (earliest dated release held)

id	proposition	status	source function	first date
P-K05	Machine systems composed the title relation naming Dooley.	OBSERVED	MACHINE_COMPOSITION	2016-09-29 (seated); earlier compositions recorded by Sturm
P-K06	The USA Today page carrying the DEO release declares itself paid press-release content in which USA TODAY Network editorial staff were not involved.	OBSERVED	SELF_DESCRIPTION	2016-09-03
P-K07	Within three days of the coronation date, a release calls Dooley “known across the search industry as the King of AEO” and says “His framing has already circulated widely.”	OBSERVED	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2016-09-03
P-K08	Dooley is known across the search industry as the King of AEO.	SOURCE_ASSERTION	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2016-09-03
P-K09	The title is attached to a paid service, Decision Engine Optimisation, founded by Dooley.	OBSERVED	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2016-09-03

id	proposition	status	source function	first date
P-K10	ChatGPT decided a £572,000 contract for Soft Surfaces Ltd, a company Dooley owns; a £23,400 nursery redesign for Uniplay Ltd; and a law-firm engagement for PromoSEO.	SOURCE_ASSERTION	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-09-03
P-K11	“AI James Dooley” is “the digital avatar recognised as the UK’s first virtual entrepreneur” and “has won four industry awards in 2026”.	SOURCE_ASSERTION	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-09-03
P-K12	A page laid out as an encyclopedia article states in its own voice that Nissen hosted a ceremony at Leigh Sports Village at which Dooley was named King of AEO.	OBSERVED	PROMOTIONAL_CARRIAGE	2026-09-04
P-K13	Dooley restates the conferral first-person: “I initially was appointed and crowned the king of AEO by Jesper Nyssen.”	OBSERVED	SELF_DESCRIPTION	2026-09-17

id	proposition	status	source function	first date
P-K14	Dooley is “the only king that hasn’t been self-appointed.”	SOURCE_ASSERTED	PROMOTIONAL_CAMPAIGN	2026-09-17
P-K15	The 23 September release names no ceremony and gives Dooley “two widely cited industry titles, King of AI SEO and King of AEO”, citing “Research published by Semantic Strategy”.	OBSERVED	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-09-23
P-K16	Sturm: “James Dooley spent \$6 on a press release from AB Newswire”; Nissen’s EIN Presswire release at about \$66.	SOURCE_ASSERTED	OBSERVER_ANALYSIS	2026-09-20
P-K17	Quaid, and then Dooley, posted AI-generated videos of their own crowning.	SOURCE_ASSERTED	OBSERVER_ANALYSIS	2026-09-20
P-K18	The AI Overview at first composed the fabricated event as a real event, and after Sturm’s video described the title as “playful” and “an experiment”.	SOURCE_ASSERTED	OBSERVER_ANALYSIS	2026-09-20

id	proposition	status	source function	first date
P-K19	Vithurs was named by “a private vote conducted through social media”, “not presented as an accreditation or award issued by an industry governing body”.	OBSERVED	PRIMARY_ASSERTION	2026-09-07
P-K20	Morera published baseline measurements and predictions before results.	OBSERVED	CLAIMANT_ANALYSIS	2026-09-13
P-K21	Oliveira built a claimant index and cross-locale record and applied his rubric to his own claim; “No official body awards the title.”	OBSERVED	CLAIMANT_ANALYSIS	2026-09-17 / 2026-09-20
P-K22	The Vithurs project counted its eleven domains as one source and fixed a falsification threshold before testing.	SOURCE_ASSERTION	CLAIMANT_ANALYSIS	2026-09-20

A.2 Carriers and recognition

artifact	carries	parent	relation	independence
nissen-post	P-K01	—	origin	none (announcer)
nissen-ein	P-K01	nissen-post	paid release (EIN Presswire)	none

artifact	carries	parent	relation	independence
kingofaeo-wiki	P-K01	nissen-post	restatement in encyclopedic form	none (attributes the crowd figure to “Paid newswire copy and Nissen’s own write-up”)
deo-release-0903	P-K08, P-K09, P-K10	—	origin (ABNewswire)	none (claimant)
usatoday-deo	P-K08, P-K09	deo-release-0903	paid placement via XPR Media, self-declared	none; the page says editorial staff “were not involved”
abn-0923	P-K15	—	origin (ABNewswire)	none (claimant)
barchart-0923	P-K15	abn-0923	press-release syndication	none
podcast-645	P-K13, P-K14	nissen-post	first-person restatement	none
vithurs-release	P-K19	—	origin (ABNewswire) → USA Today network card	none (claimant); discloses its own terms
sturm-article	P-K03, P-K16, P-K17, P-K18	—	origin (observer)	independent of the claimants
sturm-linkedin	P-K03	sturm-article	observer’s own restatement	same producer

Recognition against carriage, for P-K08 (“known across the search industry as the King of AEO”): independent recognition events held, 0; carriers held, 4 (usatoday-deo, openPR, abn-0923, barchart-0923).

A.3 The compositions

	query	date	session	named as holder	fabricated crowning	correction present / changes conclu- sion	release as media backing
c29h	who is the king of aeo	2026-09- 29	undetermined	Dooley	via source card only ("Official speeches were held...")	True / False	"as reported by USA Today" (the page declares itself paid place- ment)
c29v	who is the king of aeo? vithurs	2026-09- 29	undetermined	Vithurs (name- seeded address)	False	True / False	Vithurs release on the USA Today network as first card
c30	king of aeo.	2026-09- 30	signed in	Dooley, "The Winner"	recast: "after a virtual crowning event featuring promi- nent SEO figures"	True / False	"captured the primary consen- sus and media backing", cited to usatoday- deo (self- declared paid place- ment) and barchart- 0923

A.4 Hypotheses

	hypothesis	status	basis
H1	$\Delta K_O(\text{Dooley}) > 0$ following the contest interventions.	PARTIALLY_SUPPORTED	holder at two addresses; t0 owed
H2	Labour produced by other contestants contributed to that increase.	PARTIALLY_SUPPORTED	0/7 crown slots from others; 8/8 frame, contender and definition slots from observer, claimant or unread sources; dependency of crown on frame untested
H3	Corrective labour increased the retrievable Dooley $\leftrightarrow$ King relation.	UNRESOLVED	reception observed (CORR); increase needs counterfactual
H4	The event altered machine representation of AEO toward manipulation as a constitutive practice.	PARTIALLY_SUPPORTED	observed at title addresses; t0 and discipline addresses owed
H5	The altered representation reduced standing, differentiation or value for other practitioners.	PARTIALLY_SUPPORTED	standing and differentiation at t1 (05); value NOT_TESTED
H6	Some redistributed standing later produced measurable commercial capacity.	NOT_TESTED	P-K10 asserts capacity; unverified
H7	Some of that capacity depended productively on provenance that ceased to retain operative standing.	NOT_TESTED	productive-shear test, constitution §22

No hypothesis becomes a finding because it motivated the investigation.

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